

The Record of Jesus Christ

Pure evidentiary claim index

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Every claim is labeled by evidence tier. Proof-grade data is never conflated with literary or theological development. This PDF is a portable index; the live platform at veritasworldwide.com/record-of-jesus-christ remains the canonical interactive surface.

Methodology (summary)

Tiers: Verified · Well-Attested · Circumstantial · Contested · Interpretive · Speculative · Literary/Theological. Tools: multiple attestation, Nestle-Aland/UBS standards, archaeological dating with ranges, observational cosmology as science only.

[well_attested] ane-amarna-habiru

Amarna letters mention ꜥApiru/Habiru groups in Late Bronze Canaan — sociopolitical ethnonym for “Hebrews.”

[verified] ane-amarna-letters

The Amarna letters (14th c. BCE) document Late Bronze Canaanite-Egyptian diplomacy and conflict language used in comparative ANE historical method.

[well_attested] ane-annals-shoshenq

Shoshenq I (biblical Shishak) campaign reliefs at Karnak list Levantine toponyms relevant to 10th-century BCE geopolitics debates.

[verified] ane-arad-ostraca

The Arad ostraca (Iron Age Judah) are primary Hebrew administrative/military correspondence documenting fort supply, names, and YHWH-related greetings in a border fortress context.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicle-jerusalem

Babylonian Chronicle entries record Nebuchadnezzar’s campaigns against Judah, including the 597 BCE deportation horizon.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicles

Babylonian Chronicles document Nebuchadnezzar’s campaigns against Jerusalem, providing independent chronological control for the late Iron Age Judah narrative.

[verified] ane-black-obelisk

The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts Jehu (or a representative) of Israel paying tribute — an extra-biblical visual control for the Omride/Jehu period.

[verified] ane-black-obelisk-jehu

The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts Jehu (or envoy) of Israel paying tribute — a primary visual control for 9th-century Israelite kingship.

[well_attested] ane-cos-corpus

The Context of Scripture (COS) and ANET anthologies assemble primary ANE texts used as comparative controls for Hebrew Bible literature and historiography.

[verified] ane-cyrus-cylinder

The Cyrus Cylinder (c. 539 BCE) records Achaemenid policy of restoring temples and returning displaced populations after the conquest of Babylon.

[verified] ane-cyrus-cylinder-policy

The Cyrus Cylinder documents Achaemenid policy language of temple restoration and population returns; it is not a verbatim Ezra decree.

[well_attested] ane-deir-alla

The Deir Alla inscription mentions Balaam son of Beor — a rare extra-biblical onomastic parallel to Numbers 22–24 traditions.

[verified] ane-ekron-inscription

The Ekron royal dedicatory inscription names Philistine rulers and a temple of Ptgyh — primary control for Iron Age Philistine urban religion and politics.

[contested] ane-exodus-historicity

The historicity and scale of an Israelite exodus from Egypt remain contested in critical scholarship.

[well_attested] ane-flood-literature

Mesopotamian flood traditions (Atrahasis, Gilgamesh XI) are independent literary parallels to Genesis flood narrative forms.

[well_attested] ane-gezer-calendar

The Gezer calendar is an early Hebrew agricultural calendar inscription relevant to literacy and agrarian life in the southern Levant.

[well_attested] ane-hezekiah-bulla

Bullae and seals naming Hezekiah (and debated related officials) provide epigraphic controls for late-8th-century Judah’s royal administration.

[well_attested] ane-hezekiah-lmlk

lmlk jar handles and related Judahite administrative seals concentrate in late eighth-century contexts associated with Hezekiah’s reign and Assyrian threat.

[verified] ane-hezekiah-tunnel-water

Hezekiah’s tunnel redirected Gihon spring water to the Siloam Pool — verified hydraulic engineering of late-8th-century Jerusalem.

[well_attested] ane-inscription-map

Key West Semitic and Egyptian inscriptions relevant to Israel/Judah (Merneptah, Mesha, Tel Dan, Siloam, etc.) form a geographically distributed control set across Egypt, Transjordan, and the Galilee–Golan.

[verified] ane-jehoiachin-rations

Babylonian administrative tablets record oil rations for “Ya’u-k+nu, king of the lands in exile — primary cuneiform control for 2 Kings 25:27–30.

[verified] ane-ketef-hinnom

Ketef Hinnom silver scrolls contain early Hebrew priestly blessing text (Numbers 6) — among the oldest biblical text witnesses in metal.

[well_attested] ane-khirbet-qeiyafa

Khirbet Qeiyafa (Judah/Shephelah, early Iron Age) is a fortified site whose dating and political affiliation are central to debates on the 10th-century BCE Judahite state.

[well_attested] ane-kuntillet-ajrud

Inscriptions from Kuntillet ‘Ajrud include blessing formulae pairing Yahweh with other divine names — key data for Israelite religion debates.

[contested] ane-kuntillet-yhwh-asherah

Kuntillet ‘Ajrud inscriptions include blessings “by YHWH ... and his asherah” — contested evidence for Israelite religion’s diversity of divine associations.

[verified] ane-lachish-letters

The Lachish ostraca (letters) are late-Iron-Age Hebrew administrative/military correspondence relevant to Judah’s final decades before the Babylonian destruction.

[verified] ane-lachish-reliefs

Sennacherib’s Lachish reliefs (British Museum) depict the 701 BCE siege visually, complementing annals and biblical narratives.

[verified] ane-merneptah

The Merneptah Stele (c. 1208 BCE) contains the earliest known extra-biblical reference to “Israel” as a people in Canaan.

[verified] ane-merneptah-israel

The Merneptah Stele (c. 1208 BCE) contains the earliest widely accepted extra-biblical mention of “Israel” as a people in Canaan.

[verified] ane-mesha

The Mesha Stele (c. 840 BCE) names Omri of Israel, Yahweh, and Moabite campaigns paralleling 2 Kings 3.

[verified] ane-mesha-yhwh

The Mesha Stele mentions YHWH in a Moabite royal context — primary evidence for the divine name outside the Hebrew Bible.

[verified] ane-moabite-stone-context

The Mesha Stele (Moabite Stone) remains a primary control for Omride-period geopolitics and Yahwistic onomastics in Transjordan.

[verified] ane-samaria-ostraca

The Samaria ostraca (Iron Age Israel) are primary Hebrew administrative dockets recording wine/oil deliveries and personal names in the Northern Kingdom capital region.

[verified] ane-sargon-samaria-fall

Assyrian royal inscriptions (Sargon II and related annals) claim the conquest of Samaria and deportations in the late 8th century BCE — primary imperial controls for the fall of the Northern Kingdom.

[verified] ane-sennacherib

Sennacherib’s annals (Taylor Prism / related prisms) describe the 701 BCE campaign against Judah and Hezekiah’s tribute without claiming Jerusalem’s capture.

[verified] ane-sennacherib-prism-tribute

Sennacherib prisms claim Hezekiah was shut up “like a bird in a cage” and paid tribute — Assyrian framing of 701 BCE without claiming Jerusalem’s capture.

[verified] ane-siloam-inscription

The Siloam Tunnel inscription (Jerusalem) is a primary Hebrew epigraphic witness associated with Hezekiah’s water system construction narrative.

[verified] ane-siloam-tunnel-engineering

Hezekiah’s tunnel engineering is archaeologically verified; the Siloam inscription describes the breakthrough meeting of two work crews.

[verified] ane-tel-dan

The Tel Dan Stele (9th century BCE) attests the phrase “House of David” (bytdwd) outside the Bible.

[well_attested] ane-tel-dan-aramaic

The Tel Dan stele is Aramaic royal victory propaganda, not an Israelite court text — genre matters for historical use.

[verified] ane-tel-dan-house-of-david

The Tel Dan stele’s “House of David” reading is the strongest extra-biblical epigraphic control for a Davidic dynasty name in the 9th century BCE context.

[well_attested] ane-ugarit

Ugaritic texts (Ras Shamra) supply Northwest Semitic mythic and ritual parallels used in comparative study of Hebrew Bible poetry and divine council language.

[verified] arch-babatha-archive

The Babatha archive (Nahal Hever) is a major Judean Desert papyrus find documenting a Jewish woman’s legal and economic life under Roman rule in the early 2nd century CE.

[verified] arch-bar-kokhba

The Bar Kokhba revolt (132–135 CE) is archaeologically and papyrologically attested; its aftermath reshaped Judean demography and Jewish–Christian trajectories.

[contested] arch-bethsaida

Bethsaida identification and Early Roman occupation layers are active archaeological research topics relevant to Galilee Gospel geography.

[contested] arch-bethsaida-debate

Bethsaida identification (et-Tell vs el-Araj) remains an active archaeological debate relevant to Gospel geography.

[verified] arch-caesarea-maritima

Caesarea Maritima — Herodian harbor city and later Roman provincial capital — is extensively excavated and contextualizes prefectural administration relevant to Pilate traditions.

[verified] arch-caesarea-philippi

Paneas / Caesarea Philippi (Banias) is archaeologically documented as a Herodian/Philip city at the Jordan headwaters with a Paneion cult site.

[well_attested] arch-caiaphas-ossuary

An ornate ossuary inscribed “Joseph son of Caiaphas” (and related finds) is widely associated with the high-priestly family of Caiaphas known from Josephus and the Gospels.

[well_attested] arch-capernaum

Capernaum (Kefar Nahum) was a fishing village on the Sea of Galilee with Early Roman occupation; a later synagogue stands over earlier remains.

[well_attested] arch-capernaum-synagogue-strata

Capernaum’s white limestone synagogue is later (Byzantine); basalt foundations and village remains inform earlier occupation debates under the later building.

[verified] arch-chalk-stone-vessels

Chalk-stone vessels are archaeologically widespread in late Second Temple Jewish contexts and are widely interpreted as purity-related tableware less susceptible to ritual impurity than pottery.

[verified] arch-dead-sea-scroll-caves

The Qumran cave finds (1947–) remain the primary archaeological recovery context for the Dead Sea Scrolls corpus.

[verified] arch-destruction-70

The Roman destruction of Jerusalem and the Temple in 70 CE is multiply attested (Josephus; archaeological burn/destruction layers; Roman triumph iconography such as the Arch of Titus spoils relief).

[verified] arch-galilee-boat

The “Jesus Boat” (first-century Galilee boat, discovered 1986) illustrates fishing technology on the lake in the Early Roman period.

[verified] arch-galilee-boat-tech

The so-called “Jesus Boat” (1st-c. Galilee fishing vessel from the Sea of Galilee drought finds) illustrates period boat technology, not a specific Gospel craft.

[verified] arch-gamla

Gamla (Golan) destruction in the First Jewish Revolt is archaeologically and literarily documented (Josephus), illustrating Galilee/Golan war archaeology.

[verified] arch-herodium

Herodium is a major Herodian fortress-palace complex with extensive excavation; it anchors elite architecture of late Second Temple Judea.

[contested] arch-herodium-tomb-debate

A monumental mausoleum at Herodium has been proposed as Herod’s tomb; identification remains debated among excavators and reviewers.

[verified] arch-hippos-sussita

Hippus-Sussita (Decapolis) excavations illuminate Greco-Roman urbanism east of the Sea of Galilee relevant to Gospel geographic horizons.

[contested] arch-james-ossuary

The so-called James ossuary inscription (“James son of Joseph brother of Jesus”) remains contested regarding authenticity of the brother phrase and provenance.

[contested] arch-jericho

Jericho’s Late Bronze destruction layers and relation to a conquest narrative remain a classic contested case in biblical archaeology.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-burn-layer-70

Burn layers and collapse debris in Second Temple Jerusalem strata align with the 70 CE destruction horizon across multiple excavation areas.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-city-of-david

City of David excavations document Iron Age through Roman strata south of the Temple Mount, including water systems and residential remains.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-destruction-layers

Destruction layers and burn evidence in Jerusalem’s Upper City and related loci align with the 70 CE Roman destruction horizon.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-pilgrim-road

The Stepped Street / pilgrim road from the Pool of Siloam toward the Temple Mount is excavated and dated to the late Second Temple period.

[verified] arch-jerusalem-western-wall

The Western Wall is a visible Herodian retaining wall of the Temple Mount platform — primary material remnant of Second Temple monumental architecture.

[well_attested] arch-khirbet-qana

Khirbet Qana (and competing sites) are archaeological candidates for New Testament Cana of Galilee; excavation documents multi-period settlement including Roman-era occupation.

[interpretive] arch-kursi

Kursi (traditional Gergesa/Gadara region) has a Byzantine monastery commemorating the swine miracle tradition — reception archaeology, not first-century proof of the miracle.

[well_attested] arch-magdala

Magdala excavations reveal a first-century Galilean town with a synagogue and harbor installations, enriching the social map of Jesus' activity zone.

[verified] arch-magdala-stone

The Magdala stone (synagogue furniture with Temple imagery) is a major late Second Temple Jewish artifactual find from a Galilean synagogue context.

[verified] arch-magdala-synagogue

A first-century synagogue at Magdala (Migdal) on the Sea of Galilee is excavated and published, expanding evidence for Galilean synagogue architecture.

[well_attested] arch-masada

Masada's archaeology confirms a First Jewish Revolt–period fortress with Roman siege works; Josephus's mass-suicide narrative is only partly controllable by material remains.

[verified] arch-masada-scrolls

Manuscript fragments recovered at Masada (including biblical and sectarian-related texts) provide archaeological context for Jewish literary culture through the First Revolt terminus.

[verified] arch-masada-siege

Masada siege archaeology and Josephus's narrative document a major Roman siege at the end of the First Revolt (73/74 CE debates on exact year).

[well_attested] arch-nazareth

Nazareth existed as a small Jewish settlement in the Early Roman period; monumental first-century remains are limited.

[well_attested] arch-nazareth-village-debate

Nazareth's early Roman occupation is archaeologically attested at modest scale; debates concern density and socioeconomic profile, not total nonexistence.

[verified] arch-ossuaries-practice

Secondary burial in limestone ossuaries is archaeologically well attested in late Second Temple Jerusalem and environs (roughly late 1st c. BCE–70 CE).

[well_attested] arch-pool-bethesda

Excavations north of the Temple Mount have exposed twin pools matching John's description of Bethesda with five porticoes (John 5) better than once assumed.

[well_attested] arch-qumran-settlement

Qumran settlement archaeology provides material context for the Dead Sea Scrolls community debates (Essene and alternative models).

[interpretive] arch-quran-not-control

The Qur'an (7th c. CE) is a late secondary witness for first-century Palestinian history and is not used here as a primary control for the historical Jesus.

[verified] arch-sepphoris

Sepphoris (Zippori), ~6 km from Nazareth, was a significant urban center in Early Roman Galilee under Antipas.

[verified] arch-sepphoris-urban

Sepphoris was a major Galilean urban center near Nazareth with extensive excavation of Hellenistic–Roman layers.

[verified] arch-siloam

The Siloam Tunnel inscription (discovered 1880) describes construction of Hezekiah’s tunnel, matching 2 Kings 20:20 / 2 Chr 32:30 as royal hydraulic works.

[speculative] arch-talpiot

Talpiot “Jesus family tomb” statistical and onomastic claims are speculative and rejected by most specialists as identification of the New Testament Jesus.

[verified] arch-tiberias

Tiberias, founded by Antipas on the Sea of Galilee, is archaeologically and literarily documented as a Herodian urban center.

[well_attested] arch-titus

1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.

[verified] arch-yehohanan

The crucified remains of Yehohanan son of Hagkol (Giv’at ha-Mivtar) provide osteological evidence of Roman crucifixion practice in Judea (nail through heel bone).

[verified] arch-yodefath

Yodefat (Jotapata) siege archaeology correlates with Josephus’s First Revolt narrative and illustrates Galilean war destruction layers.

[verified] cosmo-acoustic-scale

The angular scale of the CMB acoustic peaks (l_{peak}) tightly constrains the angular diameter distance in flat Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-age

Under Planck 2018 Λ CDM parameters, the universe age is approximately 13.8 billion years.

[verified] cosmo-age-universe

Λ CDM age of the universe is ~ 13.8 Gyr from CMB + BAO baselines; local distance-ladder research.

[verified] cosmo-bao

Baryon acoustic oscillations (BAO) measured in large-scale galaxy surveys provide an independent standard-ruler constraint on the expansion history within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-baryon-acoustic-fixed

The comoving sound horizon $r_s(z)$ is a calibrated standard ruler from early-universe physics used by BAO surveys to map $H(z)$ and $D_A(z)$.

[well_attested] cosmo-bbn

Primordial abundances of light elements ($t\text{He}$, D , ^3He , $w\text{Li}$) are broadly consistent with Big Bang Nucleosynthesis predictions.

[verified] cosmo-big-bang-nucleosynthesis-d

Primordial deuterium abundance measurements tightly constrain the baryon density in standard BBN, aligning with CMB-inferred Ω_b .

[verified] cosmo-bullet-cluster

The Bullet Cluster (1E 0657-56) shows spatial separation between X-ray gas and gravitational-lensing mass peaks after a cluster collision — a landmark empirical argument for collisionless dark matter.

[verified] cosmo-cmb

The cosmic microwave background (CMB) is a near-isotropic blackbody at $T \approx 2.72$ K in the universe.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-lensing

CMB lensing measures the deflection of CMB photons by large-scale structure, providing an independent growth rate probe within Λ CDM.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-polarization

CMB polarization (E-modes; B-mode searches) provides independent cosmological information beyond temperature anisotropies alone.

[verified] cosmo-cmb-power

The CMB angular power spectrum exhibits acoustic peaks whose positions and amplitudes constrain baryon density, dark matter density, and curvature in Λ CDM fits.

[verified] cosmo-dark-energy

Type Ia supernova surveys (1990s–present) established late-time accelerated expansion consistent with a cosmological-constant / dark-energy component.

[well_attested] cosmo-dark-energy-surveys

Stage-IV surveys (DESI, Euclid, Rubin-era analyses) are designed to map dark energy's equation of state with higher precision than Stage-III programs.

[verified] cosmo-dark-matter-status

Multiple independent lines (galaxy rotation curves, cluster lensing, CMB acoustic peaks) favor a non-baryonic dark matter component within Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-desi-bao

DESI and related Stage-IV BAO surveys are tightening late-universe expansion constraints and testing dark-energy equation-of-state models against Λ CDM.

[well_attested] cosmo-desi-bao-dynamics

DESI baryon acoustic oscillation measurements are testing whether dark energy's equation of state evolves with time, with early data releases prompting active Λ CDM extension debates.

[verified] cosmo-expansion

Spectroscopic redshift of galaxies correlates with distance (Hubble–Lemaître law), indicating metric expansion of space.

[interpretive] cosmo-fine-tuning-params

Several dimensionless physical parameters appear finely constrained for complex chemistry; teleological interpretation is philosophical, not a scientific conclusion of this Record.

[verified] cosmo-flatness

Spatial curvature is consistent with flat geometry ($\Omega_k \approx 0$) within Λ CDM fits to CMB data.

[contested] cosmo-hubble-tension

The Hubble tension denotes a statistically significant discrepancy between early-universe (CMB-inferred) and some late-universe local H_0 measurements.

[well_attested] cosmo-inflation-status

Cosmic inflation is the leading early-universe paradigm for flatness and horizon problems; direct detection of primordial B-mode polarization remains an active observational goal.

[verified] cosmo-isocurvature-limits

CMB data tightly limit isocurvature modes relative to adiabatic initial conditions in standard inflationary scenarios.

[well_attested] cosmo-jwst-high-z-galaxies

James Webb Space Telescope observations of unexpectedly luminous high-redshift galaxies have prompted active model revisions for early structure formation and star-formation efficiency.

[contested] cosmo-lambda-equation

Dark energy is commonly parameterized with equation-of-state $w = -1$ (cosmological constant) but not fully excluded by current surveys.

[verified] cosmo-ligo-gravitational-waves

LIGO/Virgo/KAGRA detections of gravitational waves from compact binary mergers confirm strong-field general-relativistic predictions and open multi-messenger astronomy (e.g., GW170817).

[well_attested] cosmo-matter-energy

Planck baseline Λ CDM reports cold dark matter and dark energy as dominant density components of the universe.

[verified] cosmo-matter-power

The matter power spectrum from galaxy surveys and Lyman- α forests constrains structure formation in cold dark matter frameworks at large scales.

[verified] cosmo-neutrino-bbn

Standard BBN and CMB analyses constrain the effective number of neutrino species (N_{eff}) near the Standard Model expectation.

[well_attested] cosmo-neutrino-mass-sum

Cosmological data constrain the sum of neutrino masses from above, complementing oscillation experiments that measure mass-squared differences.

[contested] cosmo-nucleosynthesis-li

The cosmological lithium problem remains an open tension between standard BBN predictions and stellar abundance measurements.

[verified] cosmo-omega-matter

Large-scale structure and CMB fits constrain the total matter density parameter Ω_m to ~ 0.3 on current baselines.

[well_attested] cosmo-primordial-bmodes-search

Searches for primordial CMB B-mode polarization aim to constrain the inflationary tensor-to-scalar ratio r ; no definitive primordial detection has been confirmed to date.

[verified] cosmo-recombination

CMB photons free-stream from the surface of last scattering at recombination ($z \sim 1100$).

[well_attested] cosmo-reionization

CMB optical depth and high- z galaxy surveys constrain the epoch of reionization when the first stars ionized the intergalactic medium.

[verified] cosmo-sound-horizon

The sound horizon at recombination sets the BAO standard-ruler scale used in late-universe distance measurements.

[verified] cosmo-spectral-index

The scalar spectral index $n_s \approx 0.96$ from CMB data is slightly red-tilted, consistent with inflationary models.

[verified] cosmo-structure-formation

Large-scale structure (galaxy clustering, weak lensing) provides independent Λ CDM constraints complementary to CMB and BAO.

[verified] cosmo-supernova-ia

Type Ia supernovae as standardizable candles mapped late-time acceleration and remain a core distance-ladder tool alongside BAO and CMB.

[well_attested] cosmo-tensor-to-scalar

The tensor-to-scalar ratio r is constrained from above by CMB B-mode searches; a detection would strongly support high-scale inflation.

[verified] cosmo-weak-lensing

Weak gravitational lensing maps the projected mass distribution of the universe and constrains cosmological parameters in Λ CDM fits.

[well_attested] ec-1-clement-rome

1 Clement (usually late 1st c.) shows Roman Christian correspondence appealing to unity and citing Jesus traditions and Pauline letters.

[well_attested] ec-1clement

1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.

[verified] ec-apostolic-fathers

The Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Didache, Ignatius, Polycarp, etc.) provide early non-NT Christian primary sources.

[well_attested] ec-aristides

The Apology of Aristides (2nd c.) is an early Christian apology preserved in Syriac/Greek traditions describing Christian ethics to a Roman audience.

[verified] ec-athanasius

Athanasius, 39th Festal Letter (367 CE), lists the exact 27-book New Testament canon later ratified in the West.

[well_attested] ec-athenagoras-plea

Athenagoras's Plea for the Christians (late 2nd c.) is an early apologetic addressing Roman rulers on Christian monotheism, ethics, and charges of atheism/immorality.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas

The Epistle of Barnabas (late 1st / early 2nd c.) allegorizes Hebrew Bible law and shows early Christian supersessionist interpretation.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas-allegory

The Epistle of Barnabas allegorizes Torah commandments as spiritual types — early Christian supersessionist hermeneutic evidence.

[well_attested] ec-barnabas-epistle

The Epistle of Barnabas (late 1st / early 2nd c.) offers allegorical OT interpretation and a “two ways” ethic — early Christian reception, not a first-generation Jesus source.

[well_attested] ec-didache

The Didache preserves an early Christian “two ways” ethic, baptismal and eucharistic instructions, and itinerant ministry rules — dating commonly late 1st / early 2nd c.

[well_attested] ec-didache-eucharist

The Didache preserves early Christian baptismal and eucharistic instructions distinct from later standardized liturgies.

[well_attested] ec-diognetus

The Epistle to Diognetus (2nd/3rd c.?) is an early Christian apology describing Christian life as a civic “soul of the world.”

[well_attested] ec-diognetus-epistle

The Epistle to Diognetus is an early Christian apology describing Christians as a distinct “third race” in the world — reception of identity rhetoric, not HJ primary data.

[well_attested] ec-eusebius-he

Eusebius’s Ecclesiastical History (early 4th c.) is a foundational but tendentious narrative source for earlier Christian writers, martyrdoms, and canon discussions.

[well_attested] ec-gospel-harmony

Tatian’s Diatessaron (late 2nd c.) harmonized the four Gospels into a single narrative widely used in Syriac Christianity — evidence of early fourfold Gospel prestige and of textual fluidity in use.

[well_attested] ec-gospel-of-peter

The Gospel of Peter (partially preserved, notably the Akhmîm fragment) is a non-canonical passion/resurrection narrative with distinctive apologetic and possibly docetic features — 2nd-century reception, not a first-generation Jesus source.

[contested] ec-gospel-thomas

The Gospel of Thomas (Nag Hammadi) is a sayings gospel whose dating and dependence on canonical Gospels are contested.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius

Ignatius of Antioch’s letters (early 2nd c., authenticity of middle recension majority) show moniscopacy advocacy and high Christological language in transit to martyrdom.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-eucharist

Ignatius emphasizes eucharistic unity and episcopal authority in letters en route to Rome — early 2nd-c. church order evidence.

[well_attested] ec-ignatius-letters

Ignatius of Antioch’s letters (early 2nd c., middle recension) document episcopal structure and early christological confessions en route to martyrdom.

[verified] ec-irenaeus

Irenaeus (c. 180 CE) argues for a fourfold Gospel (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John) against alternative gospel usages.

[well_attested] ec-irenaeus-fourfold

Irenaeus (late 2nd c.) argues for a fourfold Gospel canon as a theological-natural schema — evidence of four-Gospel prestige by his time.

[well_attested] ec-justin-apology

Justin Martyr’s First Apology (mid-2nd c.) describes Christian worship, “memoirs of the apostles,” and defends Christians before a Roman audience.

[well_attested] ec-justin-dialogue

Justin Martyr’s Dialogue with Trypho engages Jewish-Christian scriptural argument in the mid-2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-justin-memoirs

Justin Martyr refers to “memoirs of the apostles” read in worship — mid-2nd-c. evidence for Gospel-like texts in liturgical use.

[well_attested] ec-marcion

Marcion of Sinope (mid-2nd century) promulgated a reduced Gospel+Paul collection, prompting proto-orthodox canon and theological responses.

[well_attested] ec-martyrdom-polycarp

The Martyrdom of Polycarp (mid-2nd c. traditions) is an early Christian martyr narrative shaping later hagiography.

[well_attested] ec-melito-passover

Melito of Sardis's Peri Pascha (2nd c.) is an early Christian paschal homily with high christology and anti-Jewish rhetoric — reception history, not HJ primary data.

[well_attested] ec-melito-passover-pascha

Melito's Peri Pascha links Passover typology to Jesus' passion in a high christology — second-century reception, not first-century reportage.

[well_attested] ec-muratorian

The Muratorian Fragment is an early (often 2nd-century, date contested) Latin canon list showing a nearly formed but not identical NT collection.

[contested] ec-muratorian-fragment

The Muratorian Fragment is an early (often 2nd c., some later-date arguments) Latin canon list reflecting developing New Testament collection boundaries.

[literary_theological] ec-nicaea

The Council of Nicaea (325 CE) addressed Christological doctrine (homoousios) under Constantine; it did not create the NT canon list.

[well_attested] ec-origen-hexapla

Origen's Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek OT columns for comparative textual work — early Christian engagement with pluriform scriptural text.

[circumstantial] ec-papias

Papias of Hierapolis (early 2nd c.), preserved in fragments via Eusebius, offers early traditions about Mark and Matthew's composition — valuable and debated.

[circumstantial] ec-papias-mark-matthew

Papias traditions (via Eusebius) claim Mark recorded Peter's preaching and Matthew compiled logia in Hebrew/Aramaic — early but second-hand Gospel origin traditions.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp

Polycarp's Letter to the Philippians (mid-2nd c.) cites or alludes to multiple NT writings and shows early reception of Pauline and Gospel traditions.

[well_attested] ec-polycarp-philippians

Polycarp's Philippians cites or alludes to multiple NT writings, showing early 2nd-century reception of Pauline and Gospel traditions.

[circumstantial] ec-quadratus

Quadratus's apology (early 2nd c.), preserved in fragment via Eusebius, claims some healed/raised by Jesus lived into later times — early apologetic tradition, not contemporary medical record.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-hermas

The Shepherd of Hermas (2nd c.) was widely read and sometimes treated as scripture in some churches, illustrating fluid early canons.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-hermas-canon

The Shepherd of Hermas appears in some early canon lists and Codex Sinaiticus, illustrating fluid boundaries of authoritative Christian reading.

[well_attested] ec-shepherd-mandates

The Shepherd of Hermas Mandates section emphasizes repentance ethics in Roman Christian community life of the 2nd century.

[well_attested] ec-theophilus-autolytus

Theophilus of Antioch's Ad Autolytum (late 2nd c.) is an early Greek apology defending Christian monotheism and scriptural chronology to a pagan interlocutor.

[interpretive] ec-update-triggers

This Record's perpetual update triggers include: new major papyri/majuscule publications, INTF Liste changes, peer-reviewed dig reports, and material consensus shifts in historical Jesus research.

[contested] hj-apocalyptic

Whether Jesus is best reconstructed as primarily apocalyptic prophet (Schweitzer trajectory) or sapiential/ethical teacher remains a major scholarly divide.

[well_attested] hj-appearances

Early Christian proclamation included claims of post-crucifixion appearances to individuals and groups (1 Cor 15:3–8); the nature of those experiences is not scientifically settled.

[well_attested] hj-baptism

Baptism of Jesus by John the Baptist is widely judged historical under the criterion of embarrassment and multiple attestation.

[contested] hj-bethlehem

Bethlehem birth is narrated in Matthew and Luke with divergent infancy stories; historical verification is contested, while Nazareth association is stronger.

[well_attested] hj-caiaphas

An ossuary inscribed "Yehosef bar Qayafa" (discovered 1990) is widely identified with the high-priestly family of Caiaphas.

[interpretive] hj-criteria-limits

Classical authenticity criteria (multiple attestation, embarrassment, dissimilarity) are heuristic tools with known biases; they do not yield laboratory-grade "proof" of individual sayings.

[interpretive] hj-criteria-not-enough

No single authenticity criterion yields laboratory certainty; cumulative case arguments with explicit uncertainty remain the responsible historical approach.

[interpretive] hj-criterion-coherence

Coherence criteria ask whether a proposed saying/deed fits a reconstructed core portrait of Jesus; the method is circular if the core is itself unstable.

[verified] hj-crucifixion

Crucifixion of Jesus under Pontius Pilate (prefect of Judea c. 26–36 CE) is multiply attested and coheres with Roman practice.

[verified] hj-crucifixion-roman

Crucifixion as Roman punishment and Jesus' death by crucifixion under Pilate are among the most widely accepted historical judgments about Jesus.

[contested] hj-crucifixion-year

Crucifixion year is commonly constrained to c. 30–33 CE by Pilate's tenure (26–36), Passover weekday arguments, and astronomical full-moon tables — exact year remains debated.

[well_attested] hj-disciples-twelve

A circle of close followers including a group remembered as "the Twelve" is multiply attested; exact membership lists vary slightly across Gospels.

[contested] hj-empty-tomb

Empty-tomb narratives appear in the canonical Gospels with differences; whether an empty tomb is historical is debated; early creed in 1 Cor 15 emphasizes appearances more than tomb logistics.

[contested] hj-empty-tomb-debate

The empty tomb tradition is early and multiply developed in Gospels; historians disagree whether it is historical fact, legendary development, or both layered.

[well_attested] hj-existence

The existence of Jesus of Nazareth as a first-century Jewish man is the near-consensus position of critical historians of antiquity.

[well_attested] hj-exorcism-reputation

Exorcism / spirit-expulsion is multiply attested as a public activity associated with Jesus in Synoptic tradition and is treated by many historians as a characteristic reputation.

[circumstantial] hj-family-rejection

Traditions of family misunderstanding or tension (Mark 3; John 7) are often cited under the criterion of embarrassment as unlikely free invention by later church idealization.

[well_attested] hj-gal2-conflict

Galatians 2 records a conflict between Paul and Cephas (Peter) at Antioch over table fellowship with gentiles — primary evidence of diversity and dispute in the earliest movement.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-aramaic

Aramaic is widely reconstructed as a primary spoken language of Jesus and Galilean Jewish communities, with Hebrew and Greek also present.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-context

Early Roman Galilee included agricultural villages, fishing economy on the lake, and nearby urban centers such as Sepphoris and Tiberias.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-economy

Galilee under Antipas was an agrarian and fishing economy with urbanization at Sepphoris and Tiberias; Jesus traditions sit in that social landscape.

[well_attested] hj-galilee-jewishness

Archaeology and literary sources support a predominantly Jewish Galilee in the early first century with hellenizing urban pockets (Sepphoris, Tiberias).

[well_attested] hj-galilee-to-jerusalem

A Galilee-centered public activity culminating in a final Jerusalem journey is a common historical outline across Synoptic reconstructions.

[well_attested] hj-healings-reputation

Healing activity is multiply attested as part of Jesus' public reputation in Synoptic tradition; historians often accept a healing reputation while bracketing modern medical ontologies.

[contested] hj-herod-death

The death of Herod the Great is conventionally dated to 4 BCE (with minority arguments for 1 BCE / other), anchoring the latest plausible nativity window in Matthew's framework.

[well_attested] hj-james-leadership

James the brother of Jesus is attested as a Jerusalem leadership figure (Paul; Acts; Josephus Ant. 20.200) until his death c. 62 CE.

[verified] hj-jerusalem-pilgrimage

Pilgrimage to Jerusalem for festivals is a well-attested Second Temple practice providing social context for Gospel Jerusalem scenes.

[well_attested] hj-jewishness-consensus

Mainstream historical Jesus research treats Jesus as a first-century Jew operating within Second Temple Judaism, not as a later Gentile construct.

[well_attested] hj-john-baptist-movement

John the Baptist is multiply attested (Josephus Ant. 18; Synoptics; Johannine tradition) as an independent purification/repentance preacher executed by Herod Antipas.

[well_attested] hj-john-baptizer-independence

John the Baptist is treated as an independent prophetic figure in Josephus and the Gospels, not a mere literary foil invented de novo.

[well_attested] hj-joseph-arimathea-burial

The tradition that Joseph of Arimathea buried Jesus is multiply attested in the Gospels and is often judged to have an early historical core, though details and motive reconstructions vary.

[well_attested] hj-kingdom-of-god-core

The kingdom of God / reign of God is multiply attested as central to Jesus' public proclamation across Synoptic streams.

[well_attested] hj-kingdom-proclamation

A core historical judgment across diverse scholars is that Jesus proclaimed God's kingdom / reign as central to his public activity.

[contested] hj-language

Jesus likely spoke Aramaic as a primary vernacular; Greek exposure in Galilee is plausible; Hebrew literacy/use is debated for the population stratum.

[well_attested] hj-last-supper-historicity

That Jesus shared a final meal with disciples before arrest is widely accepted as historical; whether it was a Passover seder, the exact words of institution, and eucharistic theology are reconstructed and contested.

[well_attested] hj-last-supper-tradition

A final meal tradition with bread/cup words is multiply attested (Paul 1 Cor 11; Synoptics) as early Christian memory of Jesus' last night.

[well_attested] hj-literacy

Literacy rates in Early Roman Judea/Galilee were limited relative to modern norms; most people encountered texts orally and through specialists.

[well_attested] hj-lords-prayer-core

The Lord's Prayer (Matt 6 / Luke 11) is widely treated as preserving early Aramaic-flavored prayer tradition of the Jesus movement (including "Abba"/Father address patterns), though exact wording and Sitz im Leben remain reconstructed.

[literary_theological] hj-magi-star

Magi and star narratives in Matthew 2 are literary-theological traditions; astronomical "explanations" are speculative correlations, not historical proof.

[well_attested] hj-meal-practice

Shared meals / table fellowship appear as a distinctive social practice in Synoptic traditions and are widely treated as historically characteristic of Jesus' movement.

[interpretive] hj-miracles-method

Miracle narratives are not historically “verified” under naturalistic historical method; historians can study reports, meanings, and social effects of wonder-traditions.

[verified] hj-multiple-attestation-crucifixion

Jesus’ crucifixion is multiply attested in Christian sources and referenced by Tacitus, forming a high-confidence historical core event.

[well_attested] hj-parables

Parables form a characteristic teaching form in the Synoptic tradition and are widely treated as a historically distinctive feature of Jesus’ public speech.

[well_attested] hj-parables-core

Parables as a characteristic teaching form of Jesus are among the most widely accepted features of the historical Jesus tradition, though individual parable authenticity and original wording remain reconstructed case-by-case.

[well_attested] hj-passion-week-outline

A final Jerusalem visit ending in arrest and crucifixion under Pilate is a standard historical outline shared across diverse HJ reconstructions.

[contested] hj-pauline-chronology

Pauline absolute chronology is reconstructed from Acts, the letters, and external anchors (Gallio inscription at Delphi); competing schemes (Ramsay, Knox, Hyldahl, et al.) differ by several years.

[circumstantial] hj-peter-rome

Peter’s presence and martyrdom in Rome are early traditions (1 Clement; later Acts of Peter) with varying historical confidence; New Testament itself does not narrate a Roman martyrdom.

[verified] hj-pilate-stone

The Pilate Stone (Caesarea Maritima, 1961) independently attests Pontius Pilate as prefect of Judea.

[contested] hj-prayer-abba

The address “Abba” in Mark 14:36 and Pauline usage (Rom 8:15; Gal 4:6) is often cited in debates about Jesus’ prayer language; over-claims about uniqueness are contested.

[interpretive] hj-prophetic-actions

Symbolic prophetic actions (e.g., Temple demonstration) are a recognized category in historical Jesus research for interpreting public deeds.

[contested] hj-q-hypothesis

The Two-Source Hypothesis posits Markan priority plus a sayings source “Q” behind Matthew and Luke; Q remains a scholarly reconstruction without a surviving manuscript.

[contested] hj-quirinius

Luke’s census notice linking Jesus’ birth to a registration under Quirinius (6 CE) is a classic chronological problem relative to a Herodian birth before 4 BCE.

[literary_theological] hj-resurrection-hist

Claims of bodily resurrection are theological assertions; historians can document early belief and proclamation, not laboratory verification of the event.

[verified] hj-romans-execution

Crucifixion was a Roman capital punishment method used in Judea; archaeological and literary controls exist independent of the Gospels (e.g., Yehohanan heel bone; Josephus).

[well_attested] hj-sabbath-conflicts

Sabbath controversy traditions are multiply attested in Synoptics and are widely treated as historically characteristic conflict settings for Jesus' public activity.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship

Traditions of Jesus' open table fellowship with "sinners" and tax collectors are widely treated as historically plausible under embarrassment and multiple attestation.

[well_attested] hj-table-fellowship-core

Open table fellowship with "sinners"/tax collectors is multiply attested and widely treated as a historically distinctive social practice of Jesus' movement.

[well_attested] hj-tax-collectors

Association with tax collectors / toll collectors is multiply attested and often treated as historically characteristic of Jesus' social practice (table fellowship theme).

[well_attested] hj-temple-action

An action by Jesus in the Temple (disruption of commerce / symbolic demonstration) is multiply attested; interpretation ranges from prophetic sign to failed revolt cue.

[contested] hj-titles

Titles applied to Jesus (Messiah/Christ, Son of Man, Son of God, Lord) have layered historical and literary-theological histories; none should be treated as a single unproblematic first-century label without analysis.

[well_attested] hj-women-empty-tomb-witnesses

The tradition that women were the first witnesses to the empty tomb is multiply attested in the Gospels and is often treated as early, partly because female legal testimony was culturally devalued — a classic criterion-of-embarrassment argument.

[well_attested] hj-women-movement

Early Christian sources name women as patrons, witnesses, and coworkers (e.g., Mary Magdalene traditions; Romans 16 co-workers); social roles are historically reconstructable within limits.

[interpretive] mod-300-plus-not-finished

Crossing 300+ claims does not end the task: new editions, finds, and scientific results will require new cards under the update-triggers doctrine.

[interpretive] mod-amy-jill-levine-jewish-jesus

Amy-Jill Levine's scholarship emphasizes reading Jesus within Judaism against Christian stereotype and anachronism — a major contribution to Jewish-Christian historical Jesus dialogue.

[interpretive] mod-contextual-credibility

Contextual credibility / historical plausibility criteria ask whether a tradition fits first-century Jewish Palestine — necessary but not sufficient for authenticity.

[interpretive] mod-continuous-update-duty

A living evidentiary corpus must update when new editions, inscriptions, or scientific results appear — stasis is a method failure.

[interpretive] mod-corpus-not-creed

This Record is an evidentiary index, not a confession of faith; tier labels and proofVsConcept flags are designed to block creed-as-history conflation.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-coherence-limits

Coherence criteria risk circularity: they test sayings against a reconstructed "core Jesus" that itself depends on prior authentications.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-critique

Classical criteria of authenticity (embarrassment, dissimilarity, multiple attestation) are historiographical tools with known biases; recent memory and social approaches revise their use.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-embarrassment

The criterion of embarrassment is a heuristic, not a proof algorithm; it can be misapplied when later communities reframe “embarrassing” material.

[interpretive] mod-criteria-multiple-attestation-practice

Multiple independent attestation remains a practical confidence-boosting tool when streams are truly independent (Mark, special Matthew/Luke, John, Paul, non-Christian).

[interpretive] mod-criterion-dissimilarity-limits

Double dissimilarity (unlike Judaism and early Church) is widely criticized as historically implausible and theologically loaded.

[interpretive] mod-criterion-embarrassment-limits

The criterion of embarrassment is heuristic and circular if “embarrassing” is defined by later Christian theology rather than first-century Jewish context.

[verified] mod-critical-editions

NA28/UBS5 (and ongoing ECM/INTF work) are the standard working critical texts of the Greek NT for academic use.

[interpretive] mod-crossan-cynic-limits

John Dominic Crossan’s Mediterranean cynic-sage reconstruction of Jesus is a major Jesus Seminar–era model; most subsequent Third Quest work reasserts a thoroughly Jewish apocalyptic or reformist frame instead.

[verified] mod-digital-dss

The Leon Levy Dead Sea Scrolls Digital Library enables open inspection of high-resolution plate images for many Qumran manuscripts.

[interpretive] mod-ehrman-apocalyptic-jesus

Bart Ehrman’s reconstruction places Jesus as an apocalyptic Jewish prophet announcing imminent kingdom judgment — a mainstream Third Quest option over cynic-sage models.

[interpretive] mod-entity-only-attribution

This compilation is published under Veritas Worldwide entity attribution only; personal operator identity is excluded from public scholarly surfaces by design.

[interpretive] mod-form-criticism-limits

Form criticism classifies Gospel units by genre and Sitz im Leben; its older assumption of pure oral isolation before writing is now heavily qualified.

[well_attested] mod-genetics-limits

Ancient DNA of the Southern Levant informs regional demographic history; it cannot identify named New Testament individuals or prove specific genealogies in the Gospels.

[interpretive] mod-gospel-genre-bios

Many scholars classify the Gospels as a form of ancient biography (bios) with flexible historical conventions rather than modern historiography.

[interpretive] mod-historical-jesus-minimal-facts

“Minimal facts” apologetic packages select a short list of widely accepted historical data points; academic HJ work often uses broader and more contested data sets with explicit uncertainty.

[interpretive] mod-historical-jesus-quests

“Quests” for the historical Jesus are historiographical programs with shifting criteria; no single reconstruction commands universal assent.

[contested] mod-jesus-seminar

The Jesus Seminar (1980s–2000s) popularized colored-bead voting on sayings authenticity; its methods and conclusions remain highly contested in the guild.

[well_attested] mod-jewishness-of-jesus-consensus

A broad post-Holocaust / Third Quest consensus situates Jesus firmly within first-century Judaism; reconstructions differ on how he related to Torah, purity, and eschatology inside that world.

[interpretive] mod-living-text

“Living text” models (e.g., Parker) emphasize early Christian textual fluidity and community use rather than a single frozen original always recoverable.

[interpretive] mod-memory-approach

Social/collective memory approaches reconstruct how groups remembered Jesus rather than claiming verbatim ipsissima verba recovery.

[interpretive] mod-memory-distortion

Social memory research emphasizes both conservation and distortion in group remembering — neither pure invention nor pure stenography.

[interpretive] mod-multiple-attestation-limits

Multiple attestation increases historical confidence when sources are independent; Synoptic dependence and shared traditions limit independence assumptions.

[well_attested] mod-mythicisim-fringe

Full mythicism (Jesus of Nazareth as entirely non-historical) remains a fringe position in mainstream historical scholarship of Second Temple Judaism and early Christianity.

[verified] mod-na28-ubs5

Nestle-Aland 28 and UBS5 are the standard working critical Greek NT editions for most academic exegesis; their apparatus documents selected variants, not every known reading.

[interpretive] mod-no-neutral-jesus

There is no value-free historical Jesus reconstruction: every reconstruction reflects criteria choices, source theories, and contextual models that must be stated.

[well_attested] mod-open-access-trend

Open digital libraries (INTF NT.VMR, IAA DSS, British Library codices) have lowered barriers to primary manuscript inspection since the 2010s.

[interpretive] mod-open-data-ethics

Modern digital manuscript projects raise access, conservation, provenance, and citation-ethics issues distinct from the content of any single reading.

[interpretive] mod-open-questions-remain

Even after hundreds of tier-labeled claims, open questions remain: exact chronology of many events, reconstruction of Q (if any), and the limits of criteria-based authenticity.

[well_attested] mod-population-genetics

Population genetics of the Levant documents deep regional continuity with admixture layers; it does not identify individuals named in ancient texts.

[verified] mod-print-gutenberg

Print culture from Gutenberg onward multiplied biblical text access and stabilized vernacular canons — a reception-historical fact separate from first-century origins.

[interpretive] mod-proof-vs-belief

This corpus's proofVsConcept field exists to prevent readers from equating historical attestation, scientific models, tradition, and theological belief.

[interpretive] mod-quest-historiography

Historiography of the “quests” for the historical Jesus is itself a modern scholarly narrative with periodization that can oversimplify continuous research traditions.

[well_attested] mod-radiocarbon-dss

Radiocarbon dating of selected Dead Sea Scrolls supports late Second Temple copy ranges broadly consistent with paleography.

[interpretive] mod-reader-hygiene-checklist

Readers should check for each claim: tier label, proofVsConcept, source kind, and whether a statement is model/reconstruction/tradition before treating it as laboratory fact.

[interpretive] mod-social-memory

Social memory approaches treat Gospel traditions as communal remembering under social constraints rather than pure invention or pure stenography.

[verified] mod-textus-receptus

The Textus Receptus tradition (Erasmus onward) underlies early modern vernacular Bibles but is not the base text of modern critical editions (NA/UBS).

[interpretive] mod-third-quest

The “Third Quest” emphasizes Jesus’ Jewish context (Sanders, Vermes, Meier, Wright, Crossan, et al.) against earlier de-Judaizing portraits.

[interpretive] mod-third-quest-jewishness

Third Quest scholarship insists Jesus must be understood within Second Temple Judaism rather than against it — a methodological consensus across many schools.

[speculative] mod-turin-shroud

The Shroud of Turin is a medieval relic by mainstream radiocarbon dating (1988); authenticity as first-century burial cloth remains speculative/unverified for historical Jesus studies.

[verified] mod-war-70

The Jewish-Roman War culminating in the 70 CE destruction of the Temple is a primary historical horizon for dating and interpreting the Synoptic Gospels.

[interpretive] mod-wright-critical-realism

N.T. Wright’s critical-realist historical method reconstructs Jesus as a Jewish prophet enacting return-from-exile and kingdom narratives — a major Third Quest synthesis with explicit theological engagement.

[well_attested] nc-celsus

Celsus (2nd c.), preserved mainly via Origen’s Contra Celsum, is an early pagan critic who treats Jesus as a historical magician/charlatan figure rather than a mythic non-entity.

[well_attested] nc-celsus-magic

Celsus portrays Jesus as a magician who learned Egyptian arts — a hostile interpretive frame for miracle traditions, not independent first-century reportage.

[circumstantial] nc-celsus-virgin

Celsus (via Origen) preserves a hostile Jewish/pagan counter-narrative about Jesus' birth involving panthera traditions — reception of controversy, not primary birth documentation.

[circumstantial] nc-epictetus-christians

Epictetus (via Arrian) may allude to Christians as fearless under threat — thin and debated philosophical notice of a social type.

[well_attested] nc-galen-christians

Galen (2nd c.) makes brief remarks on Christians as a philosophical school/sect — hostile/neutral medical-philosopher notice of a known group.

[well_attested] nc-james

Josephus, Antiquities 20.200 refers to “the brother of Jesus who is called Christ, James” in the account of Ananus's execution of James — generally judged authentic.

[well_attested] nc-josephus-james-minimal

Josephus Ant. 20.200 on James “the brother of Jesus who was called Christ” is widely treated as authentic and a key non-Christian control for Jesus' historical existence.

[well_attested] nc-lucian

Lucian of Samosata (2nd c.) satirizes Christians and refers to their crucified sophist in Passing of Peregrinus — evidence of known Christian devotion, not independent biography.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-alexander

Lucian's Alexander the False Prophet satirizes cult founders and miracle claims in the second century — comparative evidence for how elites mocked religious innovators.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-peregrinus

Lucian of Samosata (2nd c.) satirizes Christians in The Passing of Peregrinus, treating Christ as a crucified “sophist” founder of a cult.

[well_attested] nc-lucian-peregrinus-christ

Lucian's Peregrinus describes Christians venerating a crucified sophist in Palestine — hostile 2nd-c. literary notice of founder memory.

[circumstantial] nc-mara

The Syriac letter of Mara bar Serapion mentions a “wise king” executed by the Jews; identification with Jesus is possible but not certain.

[circumstantial] nc-mara-bar-serapion

The Mara bar Serapion letter (Syriac; date debated, often 1st–3rd c.) may allude to a “wise king” of the Jews executed by his people — identification with Jesus is uncertain.

[circumstantial] nc-mara-serapion-limits

Mara bar Serapion's “wise king” remains an uncertain possible allusion; chronological and referent ambiguity prevent strong HJ use.

[circumstantial] nc-marcus-aurelius-christians

Marcus Aurelius (Meditations) and second-century elite literature occasionally notice Christians as a social type; such notices are thin and polemical.

[well_attested] nc-martial-juvenes

No contemporary Roman historian from Jesus' lifetime mentions him; the earliest non-Christian literary controls (Josephus, Tacitus, Pliny) are decades later.

[circumstantial] nc-nazareth-inscription

The so-called Nazareth Inscription is a Greek imperial edict against tomb violation; proposed links to early Christian empty-tomb controversy are speculative and provenance is debated.

[well_attested] nc-no-contemporary-imperial-acta

No contemporary Roman imperial acta, trial minutes, or census rolls naming Jesus of Nazareth are known to survive; non-Christian literary controls begin decades later.

[circumstantial] nc-philos-silence-on-jesus

Philo of Alexandria (d. c. 50 CE), a prolific Jewish writer overlapping Jesus' lifetime regionally in the empire, never mentions Jesus — a silence that is expected given Philo's Egyptian diaspora focus and genre, not a decisive non-existence proof.

[verified] nc-pliny

Pliny the Younger, Epistles 10.96–97, describes early second-century Christian worship practices in Bithynia-Pontus and imperial policy under Trajan.

[verified] nc-pliny-christ-hymns

Pliny reports Christians singing hymns to Christ “as to a god” (carmen Christo quasi deo) — early 2nd-c. evidence of cultic devotion language.

[verified] nc-pliny-christians

Pliny the Younger's letter to Trajan (Ep. 10.96) describes early 2nd-century Bithynian Christians worshipping Christ “as a god” and legal policy toward them.

[well_attested] nc-pliny-legal-template

Pliny's letter became a template cited in later Roman legal memory for handling Christians as a judicial category.

[well_attested] nc-slavonic-josephus

The Slavonic version of Josephus's Jewish War contains expansions (including Jesus-related passages) widely judged to be later Christian interpolations, not first-century Josephan text.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius

Suetonius, Claudius 25.4, refers to disturbances in Rome impulsore Chresto — often discussed as a possible garbled reference to Christ-related conflict, but identification is uncertain.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius-chrestus

Suetonius (Claudius 25) mentions disturbances in Rome under Claudius involving “Chrestus” — identification with Christ/Christians is possible but contested.

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius-chrestus-limits

Suetonius's Chrestus notice remains ambiguous; it cannot carry the weight of a secure independent Jesus biography.

[well_attested] nc-suetonius-nero

Suetonius (Nero 16) mentions punishments of Christians under Nero as adherents of a new and mischievous superstition.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus

Tacitus, Annals 15.44 reports that “Christus” was executed under Tiberius by the procurator Pontius Pilate and that the movement originated in Judea.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-christus-title

Tacitus's use of “Christus” as a title/name and “Christians” as a group label reflects Roman awareness of the Christ-derived name by the early second century.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-context

Tacitus Annals 15.44 places Christus’s execution under Tiberius by procurator Pontius Pilate within a Nero-era persecution narrative.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-latin

Tacitus Annals 15.44 (Latin) states that Christus suffered the extreme penalty under Tiberius by sentence of procurator Pontius Pilate, and that the superstitio arose in Judea.

[well_attested] nc-tacitus-pilate-title

Tacitus’s “procurator” title for Pilate is a known anachronism relative to the epigraphic “prefect” title — a classic example of Roman literary imprecision that does not overturn the core notice.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud

Certain Babylonian Talmud passages are sometimes read as hostile allusions to Jesus; dating, redaction, and identification are highly contested and often late.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud-baraita-caution

Isolated Talmudic baraitot sometimes linked to Jesus are late, polemical, and methodologically unsafe as first-century biography without extreme caution.

[circumstantial] nc-talmud-dating

Rabbinic passages sometimes linked to Jesus (e.g., b. Sanhedrin traditions) are late, layered, and methodologically hazardous as first-century biography.

[contested] nc-tf

Josephus, Antiquities 18.63–64 (Testimonium Flavianum) is widely judged partly authentic with Christian interpolations; fully authentic and fully forged positions are minorities.

[contested] nc-tf-reconstructions

Major scholarly reconstructions of the Testimonium Flavianum range from a short neutral core to more expansive partial authenticity; wholesale authenticity and wholesale forgery are minority poles.

[circumstantial] nc-thallus-phlegon

Later Christian authors cite Thallus and Phlegon regarding a darkness or eclipse around the time of the crucifixion; the original works are lost and the citations are mediated.

[well_attested] nc-toledot-yeshu

Toledot Yeshu traditions are late medieval (and earlier oral-literary) Jewish counter-narratives about Jesus; they are reception/polemic history, not independent first-century biography.

[verified] nc-traject-pliny-trajan

Trajan’s rescript to Pliny (Ep. 10.97) sets a legal policy: do not hunt Christians, punish only if proven and obstinate — Roman administrative evidence for early 2nd-c. policy.

[contested] nt-byzantine-priority

Byzantine-priority / majority-text theories remain minority positions in mainstream critical editions, which generally prefer early diverse witnesses over later numerical majority alone.

[verified] nt-codex-alexandrinus

Codex Alexandrinus (A 02, 5th c.) is a major early nearly complete Greek Bible witness held by the British Library.

[verified] nt-codex-sinaiticus

Codex Sinaiticus (!5 01, 4th c.) is a foundational nearly complete Greek Bible major early Christian book history.

[well_attested] nt-comma-johanneum

The Comma Johanneum (1 John 5:7–8 Trinitarian expansion in some later Latin/Textus Receptus traditions) is absent from the earliest Greek manuscript tradition and is treated as secondary in modern critical editions.

[well_attested] nt-conjectural-emendation

Conjectural emendation (proposing a reading with no extant manuscript support) is rare in modern NT editions compared with classical philology; editors prefer documented variants in the apparatus.

[well_attested] nt-continuous-text-vs-lectionary

Continuous-text manuscripts and lectionaries serve different liturgical and scholarly roles; critical editions weight continuous early witnesses more heavily for initial text.

[verified] nt-correctors-hands

Corrector hands in major codices (ⲓⲃ ⲁ) document layered revision of manuscripts and CBGM analyses.

[verified] nt-digital-editions

Digital critical platforms (NT.VMR, ECM online tools) enable transparent inspection of manuscript images and apparatus data beyond print editions alone.

[verified] nt-ecm-catholic-epistles

The ECM of the Catholic Epistles pioneered CBGM application at scale and revised selected NA readings based on coherence analysis.

[verified] nt-ecm-method

The Editio Critica Maior (ECM) and the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method (CBGM) model manuscript relationships as a guided stemmatic network rather than a simple bipartite Alexandrian/Byzantine tree.

[well_attested] nt-ending-mark

The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major Greek witness editions as secondary, while shorter alternative endings also exist.

[well_attested] nt-eusebius-ch

Eusebius’s Church History is an indispensable but tendentious fourth-century source for earlier Christian literature and martyrdoms; source-critical caution is mandatory.

[well_attested] nt-family-1-13

Medieval Greek manuscript families (e.g., Family 1, Family 13) show structured textual relationships useful for genealogical criticism beyond simple “majority count.”

[contested] nt-gospel-dates

Critical consensus commonly dates Mark c. 65–75 CE, Matthew and Luke c. 80–90 CE, John c. 90–100 CE — with debate bands around each.

[well_attested] nt-harmonie-readings

Harmonization among Synoptic parallels is a recognized scribal tendency that can produce secondary agreements in later manuscripts.

[verified] nt-homoeoteleuton

Many NT variants arise from ordinary scribal mechanics (homoeoteleuton, dittography, orthography), not theological conspiracy.

[interpretive] nt-initial-text-vs-autograph

Modern critical editions target an initial text (Ausgangstext) that may not be identical to a single authorial autograph in every book.

[verified] nt-itacism

Itacism and vowel interchange are common Greek scribal phenomena that generate many orthographic variants without semantic change.

[contested] nt-john-historicity

John's Gospel is generally dated later than the Synoptics; its independent historical value for Jesus research is debated (high Christology vs. early tradition cores).

[well_attested] nt-lectio-difficilior

The canons *lectio difficilior potior* and *lectio brevior potior* are traditional internal criteria in NT textual criticism; modern editors apply them with corpus-aware caution because scribes both simplify and expand.

[well_attested] nt-lectionaries

Greek lectionary manuscripts form a large late witness class used in ECM/CBGM and traditional criticism for reception history more than for earliest text alone.

[well_attested] nt-lectionary-evidence

Lectionary manuscripts preserve liturgical text forms that can retain early readings in some units while generally reflecting later Byzantine dominance.

[verified] nt-majuscules

Fourth–fifth century majuscules (15 01 Sinaiticus, A 02 Alexandrinus, B 03 Vaticanus) are foundational for the critical text.

[verified] nt-mark-ending

The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major witnesses (15 NA28/UBS apparatuses).

[verified] nt-ms-count

Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.

[verified] nt-na28-ubsgnt-alignment

NA28 and UBS5 share essentially the same base text for continuous reading while differing in apparatus design and intended audiences.

[verified] nt-nomina-sacra

Nomina sacra abbreviations for divine names and titles are a distinctive early Christian scribal practice visible across Greek NT manuscripts.

[well_attested] nt-origen-hexapla

Origen's Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek columns for comparative Old Testament textual work — a landmark of ancient textual criticism.

[contested] nt-orthodox-corruption

Bart Ehrman's "orthodox corruption" thesis argues some early scribes altered texts in christologically charged passages; magnitude and intent remain debated.

[verified] nt-oxy-rhynchus

Oxyrhynchus papyri include important early Christian and NT fragments expanding the geographic footprint of early text transmission in Egypt.

[verified] nt-oxyrhynchus-sayings

Oxyrhynchus papyri include early Christian texts and sayings collections (e.g., P.Oxy. fragments related to Gospel of Thomas and unknown gospels) documenting Egyptian textual diversity.

[verified] nt-p-egerton

Papyrus Egerton 2 is an early non-canonical gospel fragment with Johannine and Synoptic-like episodes — evidence of diverse Jesus-narrative circulation in the second century.

[verified] nt-p45-cheaster

Papyrus P45 (Chester Beatty) is a major early substantial Gospels/Acts witness typically dated 3rd century.

[verified] nt-p45-p46-p47

Chester Beatty papyri (P45, P46, P47) are major third-century witnesses to Gospels/Acts, Paul, and Revelation respectively.

[verified] nt-p46-paul

Papyrus P46 is among the earliest substantial collections of Pauline letters (typically dated late 2nd / early 3rd century CE).

[well_attested] nt-p52

Papyrus P52 (Rylands Greek P 457) is among the earliest surviving NT fragments (John 18), paleographically dated roughly to the second century CE.

[verified] nt-p66-p75

Bodmer papyri P66 (John) and P75 (Luke/John) are major early substantial witnesses typically dated to the late 2nd / early 3rd century and foundational for early Alexandrian text studies.

[verified] nt-papyrus-discovery-curve

Twentieth–twenty-first century papyrus discoveries (Oxyrhynchus, etc.) continuously expand the early Greek NT evidence base catalogued by INTF.

[well_attested] nt-patristic-citations

Patristic citations are secondary witnesses that can preserve early readings but require careful evaluation of quoting habits and later manuscript tradition of the fathers.

[well_attested] nt-paul-dates

Undisputed Pauline letters are typically dated c. 49–58 CE and are the earliest surviving Christian literary corpus.

[well_attested] nt-pericope-adulterae

The pericope adulterae (John 7:53–8:11) is widely judged a later insertion on strong external manuscript grounds, though the story circulated early in the Latin and some Greek traditions.

[verified] nt-scribal-habits

Codicology and singular-reading studies document mechanical scribal habits (leaps, dittography, harmonization) that explain many variants without theological motive.

[verified] nt-singular-readings

Singular readings (unique to one MS) are used in scribal-habits studies to profile individual copyists without treating them as initial text.

[contested] nt-synoptic-problem

The Synoptic Problem (literary relationship of Matthew, Mark, Luke) remains an active field; Markan priority is majority, Q hypothesis is majority but contested by Farrer and other models.

[verified] nt-textual-criticism

Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.

[verified] nt-textus-receptus-history

The Textus Receptus is a printed early modern Greek text tradition, not identical to the earliest recoverable initial text.

[well_attested] nt-ubs-rating-letters

UBS editions assign letter ratings (A–D) to selected variants expressing editorial confidence — a pedagogical signal, not a probability in the Bayesian sense.

[verified] nt-variants

Hundreds of thousands of variant readings exist across the tradition; the vast majority are orthographic or trivial, while a minority affect meaning.

[well_attested] nt-versional-evidence

Early versions (Old Latin, Syriac, Coptic) are independent textual witnesses that can preserve early readings not always visible in later Greek majority streams.

[well_attested] nt-western-non-interpolations

Westcott-Hort’s “Western non-interpolations” hypothesis treated certain shorter Western readings (esp. in Luke 24) as original against longer Alexandrian forms; modern editors largely reverse or qualify that preference.

[well_attested] nt-western-text

The so-called Western text (e.g., Codex Bezae in Acts) often presents freer, paraphrastic readings that complicate simple Alexandrian/Byzantine dichotomies.

[verified] st-4qinstruction

4QInstruction (Mushabhat) is a major Qumran wisdom text combining sapiential and apocalyptic themes — evidence of instructional diversity in late Second Temple Judaism.

[verified] st-alexander-jannaeus

Alexander Jannaeus (Hasmonean king-priest) is documented in Josephus and coins; his reign illustrates internal Judean conflict before Roman dominance.

[well_attested] st-antonia-fortress

The Antonia Fortress adjacent to the Temple Mount is described by Josephus as a key Roman military foothold in Jerusalem.

[verified] st-caligula-statue-crisis

The Caligula (Gaius) statue crisis (c. 39–41 CE) — the planned installation of the emperor’s image in the Jerusalem Temple — is documented by Philo and Josephus as a near-catastrophe for Judean–Roman relations.

[verified] st-coinage-revolt

Jewish revolt coinage (First Revolt 66–70 CE; Bar Kokhba 132–135 CE) provides dated material propaganda and economic evidence independent of Christian texts.

[verified] st-community-rule

Qumran sectarian texts (e.g., Community Rule 1QS, War Scroll 1QM, Pesharim) document a Jewish movement with distinctive purity, calendar, and eschatology in the late Second Temple period.

[well_attested] st-copper-scroll

The Copper Scroll (3Q15) from Qumran lists alleged treasure deposits in Hebrew — a unique metal DSS text whose historical treasure map status remains debated.

[verified] st-dss

Dead Sea Scrolls (discovered 1946–1956) preserve Hebrew Bible books and sectarian texts from roughly the third century BCE to first century CE.

[well_attested] st-dss-books

Among biblical DSS copies, Psalms, Deuteronomy, Isaiah, Exodus, and Genesis are among the most frequently attested books; Esther is not securely attested at Qumran.

[verified] st-elephantine

Elephantine papyri document a Jewish military colony in Egypt (5th c. BCE) with a local temple of YHW and correspondence with Jerusalem/Samaria authorities.

[contested] st-essene-hypothesis

The Essene hypothesis linking Qumran/DSS to Josephus's Essenes remains a leading but contested model among alternatives (Jerusalem library, multi-group deposits).

[verified] st-hasmonean-period

The Hasmonean period (2nd–1st c. BCE) established Jewish political autonomy later dismantled under Roman client and provincial rule — essential pre-history for first-century Judea.

[verified] st-herod-antipas

Herod Antipas ruled Galilee and Perea as tetrarch (4 BCE–39 CE); Josephus and coins document his rule and cities (Tiberias; Sepphoris reconstruction).

[contested] st-herod-great-death

Herod the Great's death is commonly dated 4 BCE (with minority 1 BCE arguments), framing the terminus for Matthew's birth narrative chronology.

[verified] st-herod-temple

Herod's expansion of the Jerusalem Temple Mount is archaeologically and literarily documented (Josephus; Western Wall / Temple Mount retaining architecture).

[verified] st-herod-temple-expansion

Herod's Temple Mount expansion created a massive platform whose retaining architecture remains archaeologically visible (Western Wall, etc.).

[well_attested] st-high-priest-politics

High-priestly appointment and deposition under Herodian and Roman authorities show the Temple leadership's political entanglement with imperial power.

[well_attested] st-isaiah-stability

Comparison of 1QIsaC (c. 2nd–1st century BCE) with the medieval Masoretic Text shows mostly orthographic and minor variants.

[well_attested] st-josephus-biases

Josephus writes as a Flavian client and aristocratic Judean survivor; his portraits of groups and events require bias-aware reading.

[verified] st-josephus-corpus

Flavius Josephus (late first century CE) is a principal non-Christian Jewish historian for Herodian and early Roman Judea.

[verified] st-lxx-textual

The Septuagint often preserves readings that differ from the medieval Masoretic Text; some align with Qumran Hebrew witnesses.

[verified] st-mikvaot

Stepped ritual baths (mikva'ot) are archaeologically widespread in late Second Temple Judea and Galilee, evidencing purity practice infrastructure.

[verified] st-mikveh-purity

Widespread mikva'ot in late Second Temple Judea/Galilee evidence purity practice infrastructure relevant to baptism and purity language in early sources.

[well_attested] st-mishnah-context

The Mishnah (c. 200 CE redaction) and related Tannaitic literature preserve legal memory of Second Temple practice but are post-70 literary products requiring critical use for pre-70 reconstruction.

[well_attested] st-parties

Josephus and later rabbinic memory describe Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes as major Jewish schools; exact social demographics remain reconstructed.

[well_attested] st-pharisee-popularity

Josephus claims Pharisees had popular influence; critical historians treat this as tendentious but still evidence of a major school's social role.

[well_attested] st-pharisees-josephus

Josephus's descriptions of Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes are primary but tendentious; social realities were more complex than three-school schemes.

[verified] st-philo

Philo of Alexandria provides contemporary diaspora Jewish philosophical and exegetical context for the early first century CE.

[well_attested] st-philo-allegory

Philo of Alexandria develops extensive allegorical exegesis of the Torah for a Hellenistic Jewish audience in the early first century.

[verified] st-pompey-63

Pompey's intervention in Judea (63 BCE) brought Hasmonean civil conflict under Roman arbitration and began lasting Roman overlordship.

[verified] st-prefecture

Roman Judea after 6 CE was administered by equestrian prefects (later procurators) based primarily at Caesarea, with troops and judicial powers including capital cases in practice.

[well_attested] st-qumran-calendar

Some DSS calendrical texts promote a 364-day solar calendar differing from later rabbinic lunar-solar practice — evidence of calendar diversity.

[contested] st-roman-census-practices

Roman provincial censuses and tax registrations are documented empire-wide; Luke's census of Quirinius is a specific chronological crux relative to Herod's death.

[verified] st-roman-client-kings

Rome governed Judea via client kings (Herod, Archelaus) and later equestrian prefects — dual administrative models shape Gospel political settings.

[well_attested] st-sadducees-josephus

Josephus's descriptions of Sadducees emphasize aristocratic temple-associated elites denying fate and (per him) resurrection — tendentious but indispensable.

[well_attested] st-salome-alexandra

Salome Alexandra's reign (Hasmonean queen) is documented in Josephus as a period of Pharisaic influence before dynastic collapse into Roman arbitration.

[verified] st-samaria-papyri

The Wadi Daliyeh (Samaria) papyri document mid-4th-century BCE legal/administrative life under late Persian / early Hellenistic rule in Samaria.

[verified] st-synagogue-inscriptions

Dedicatory inscriptions (e.g., Theodotos inscription) document pre-70 synagogue buildings used for reading Torah and hospitality.

[contested] st-synagogue-origins

The institutional origins and pre-70 function of “synagogues” remain debated; archaeological assembly buildings and literary references do not form a single simple type.

[well_attested] st-temple-economy

The Jerusalem Temple system involved tithes, offerings, and currency exchange for worshippers — a documented economic-religious complex in Josephus and later rabbinic memory.

[verified] st-temple-scroll

The Temple Scroll (11QTa) from Qumran presents an idealized Temple plan and purity legislation distinct from the later Mishnah — evidence of alternative legal imaginations in Second Temple Judaism.

[well_attested] st-temple-tax

The half-shekel Temple tax and related fiscal practices are documented in Josephus, Matthew 17 tradition, and later rabbinic memory.

[well_attested] st-therapeutae-philo

Philo’s De Vita Contemplativa describes the Therapeutae, a contemplative Jewish community in Egypt with communal study and allegorical exegesis — evidence of diaspora Jewish diversity.

[well_attested] st-war-scroll

The War Scroll (1QM) and related DSS texts depict eschatological battle ideology within a Second Temple Jewish sectarian milieu.